Poisoning

Check: **ABCDE**

- **Swallowed poison.** Remove anything remaining in the person's mouth. If the suspected poison is a household cleaner or other chemical, read the container's label and follow instructions for accidental poisoning.
- **Poison on the skin.** Remove any contaminated clothing using gloves. Rinse the skin for 15 to 20 minutes in a shower or with a hose.
- **Poison in the eye.** Gently flush the eye with cool or lukewarm water for 20 minutes or until help arrives.
- **Inhaled poison.** Get the person into fresh air as soon as possible.
- **If the person vomits,** turn his or her head to the side to prevent choking.
- **Begin CPR if the person shows no signs of life,** such as moving, breathing or coughing.
- **Have somebody gather pill bottles, packages or containers with labels,** and any other information about the poison to send along with the ambulance team.
- **Call Kuwait poison control center Tel: 1804774**

N.B ..

- **Induction of vomiting is contraindicated because vomiting may lead to additional esophageal injury if gastric contents come in contact with the esophageal mucosa.**
- **Neutralizing agents should not be used, because of concern about additional damage from heat injury during the neutralization process.**
- **Diluting agents (e.g., milk or water) should not be given, because of safety considerations and lack of efficacy.**
    - The safety concern is that ingestion of a large volume of a diluting agent can induce vomiting, potentially leading to further complications.
    - In the presence of acute airway swelling and obstruction, diluting agents clearly are contraindicated.
    - In addition, the amount of milk or other fluids that would be necessary to significantly dilute a caustic agent is too large to make such therapy practical.
- **Activated charcoal generally should not be given to children who have ingested acidic or alkaline corrosives (e.g., sodium or potassium hydroxide, or hydrochloric or sulfuric acid). This is because charcoal will obstruct the view of the endoscopist and because these small, highly ionized chemicals are poorly absorbed by charcoal**

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